DENIS STEPANOV

Mobile Team Lead · React Native

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SUMMARY

Mobile team lead with 7+ years in software and 6 in React Native, leading teams of up to 6 engineers across Russian and international products. I build the delivery system as much as the app: release cadence, CI/CD, code review and QA gates — and the engineers who run them. Took a B2C app to 1M+ downloads and raised crash-free sessions from 85% to 97%. I lead AI-first teams, embedding Cursor and Claude Code into implementation and review, which cut delivery time by ~30%. Hands-on in the codebase. English C2, remote (GMT+7), open to relocation.

CORE SKILLS

Mobile: React Native, TypeScript, Expo, EAS Build, React Native New Architecture (Fabric, TurboModules, JSI), Reanimated, FlashList, MMKV, offline-first sync, deep linking, push notifications, Redux, MobX, App Store & Google Play releases

Native: Kotlin (intermediate), Swift (basic), native module integration, platform APIs for iOS and Android

AI-assisted engineering: AI-assisted development with Cursor and Claude Code; AI-augmented code review; prompt engineering for development workflows; MCP integrations with Jira and Figma; AI-generated Jest test suites; LLM-driven auto-translation and history-based form autofill shipped in production

Frontend & backend: Vue, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, GraphQL, Node.js (Express), REST API, Firebase, MySQL, SQLite

Delivery: CI/CD, automated testing, code review, release management, Crashlytics, Mixpanel, AppMetrica, Git, Jira, Figma, Agile/Scrum

EXPERIENCE

Mobile Dev Lead — Softline AG

Jul 2022 – Present · 4 yrs 5 mos · Remote

Enterprise IT integrator and software vendor

- Led a mobile team of 4 engineers building a retail-automation app for iOS and Android in React Native and TypeScript; owned architecture, delivery and hiring.
- Established a predictable release train — 100+ production releases over three years, replacing ad-hoc shipping with a fixed weekly cadence.
- Raised crash-free sessions from 85% to 97% by introducing error budgets, structured logging and a production incident triage process.
- Introduced code review, CI/CD on EAS Build and automated testing, cutting regression time from 2–3 days to 5–6 hours per release.
- Embedded AI-assisted development into the team workflow — Cursor and Claude Code for implementation and review, MCP integrations with Jira and Figma, AI-generated Jest suites — cutting delivery time by ~30% without adding headcount.
- Hired and onboarded 5+ engineers; ran mentoring and review practice that moved 3 juniors to middle within 5–6 months.
- Delivered audit web tooling in Vue and TypeScript (MD Audit) serving close to 500K users, and shipped LLM-driven auto-translation and history-based form autofill into the CRM input flow.

Mobile Development Team Lead — Briskly

Mar 2021 – Jul 2022 · 1 yr 5 mos · Moscow, Russia

Cashierless retail and smart-fridge platform

- Led a team of 5 engineers building B-PAY, a cashierless retail app that reached 1M+ downloads.
- Owned the mobile roadmap with product and backend, shipping 30+ releases across two apps in twelve months.
- Shipped Briskly Business, a separate CRM app for merchants, managers, couriers and support, from zero to production in three months.
- Implemented auth, QR scanning, in-app payments and push notifications; the payment flow completed in 1.8s median at a 96% success rate.

Mobile Engineer — Sycret

May 2020 – Apr 2021 · 1 yr · Moscow, Russia

White-label platform for beauty and medical clients

- Migrated a CRM product from C#/Xamarin to React Native, consolidating two codebases into one serving iOS and Android.
- Built a modular white-label architecture letting one codebase ship 23 branded apps to the App Store and Google Play for 100K end users, cutting per-client launch time from seven days to two.
- Implemented booking, online payments, push notifications and marketing integrations shared across every white-label build.
- Automated build and release for the whole app line, publishing three apps per cycle with no manual steps.

CONTRACT ENGAGEMENTS

Engagements run alongside the roles above, scoped to defined deliverables and release cycles.

React Native Developer — Foodspace (cakeiteasy)

Feb 2026 – Present · 10 mos · Norway · Remote, contract

Foodtech ordering platform serving 600+ bakery locations

- Built the mobile ordering app from scratch and shipped a full production release — not a prototype — within six months.
- Delivered order processing at parity with the web platform, which handles up to 300 orders a day across 600+ bakery locations.
- Work with a Norwegian product team across a 5-hour time difference on a biweekly release cadence.

React Native Developer — WorkCircle

Jun 2023 – Aug 2025 · 2 yrs 3 mos · Tokyo, Japan · Remote, contract

Job-search platform for the Japanese market

- Led a cross-platform job-search app from architecture to App Store and Google Play release; grew it to 8K monthly active users over twelve months.
- Shipped a Japanese-language product end to end — CJK typography, text expansion and locale-specific UX — working directly with a Japanese design and backend team.
- Built Reanimated-driven animation and optimised interactive SVG rendering across both platforms, with iOS as the primary target; maintained a 100% strictly-typed TypeScript codebase.

React Native Developer — Foxford

Feb 2024 – Dec 2024 · 11 mos · Remote, contract

Online education platform

- Took over an established education app serving 1M+ students, parents and teachers and led its next stage of growth across performance, release infrastructure and distribution.
- Extended distribution from two stores to four — App Store, Google Play, RuStore and Huawei AppGallery — maintaining every store build from a single codebase.
- Raised crash-free sessions to 96% and improved responsiveness on low-end Android devices, 45% of the user base.
- Rebuilt key screens with Reanimated-driven animation and adaptive phone and tablet layouts, bringing the app in line with current mobile standards.

SIDE PROJECTS

- **Urace** — social racing platform where runners compete through real-time challenges, leaderboards and global events. React Native, TypeScript, Firebase, OneSignal. Built and shipped with a small self-assembled team; 12K registered users. urace.me

EDUCATION

- **BSc Computer Science** — University of Nottingham (UNNC), Ningbo, China · Aug 2017 – Jun 2020
- **Computer Engineering Technology Diploma** — Humber College, Toronto, Canada · Aug 2014 – May 2017

LANGUAGES

Russian — native · English — C2, fluent · Japanese — A1 (working toward JLPT N3) · Chinese — A1 (working toward HSK 3)

PUBLICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Stepanov D. et al. “A Virtual Reality OER Platform to Deliver Phobia-motivated Experiences.” IEEE COMPSAC 2020, pp. 1528–1533.
- “Creating a 4D photoreal VR environment to teach civil engineering.” IEEE TALE 2019, pp. 1006–1013. · FLEX exchange program winner · Best UNNC dissertation, 2020.